

THE WHITE HOUSE

WASHINGTON

POLICY MEMORANDUM

DATE: March 16th, 2026

FROM: Megan Fife

SOURCES: [PBS News](#), [The Hill](#), [DW](#), [CNN](#), [NY Times](#), [Reuters](#)

TOPIC: Ukraine Supplies Drones to Support Against Iran

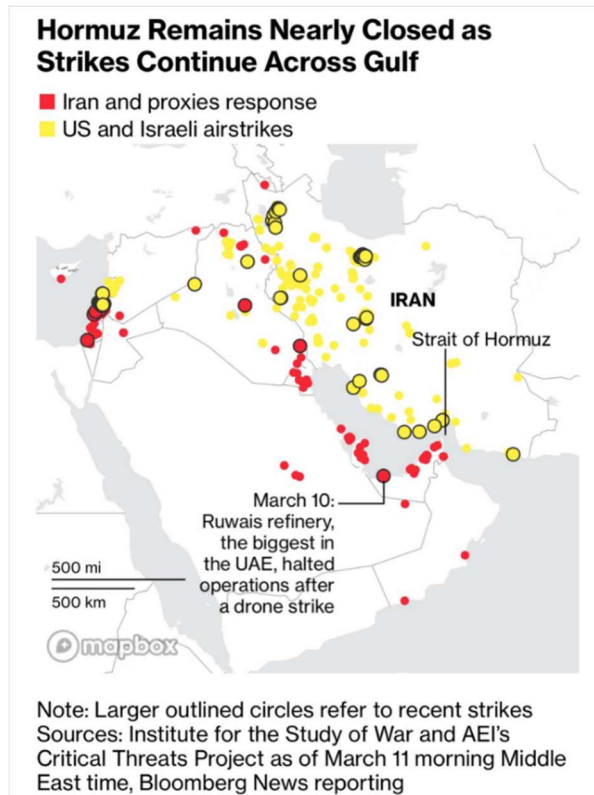
ISSUE: Whether the U.S. will sign Ukraine's drone production proposal. They have offered drones and teams to be boots on the ground to help U.S. and middle eastern countries against Iran in the war.

BACKGROUND: Ukraine has been fighting with Russia since February 22, 2022, and have developed their own, low cost, anti-Shahed drone defense systems. The Iranian drone costs \$30,000 - \$50,000 to produce in Moscow vs. the \$3 million for a patriot interceptor missile that U.S. is using to defend against them. Ukraine produces tiny interceptors that cost \$5,000 and has downed 87% of Russian drones modeled after the Iranian Shahed. Ukraine team of experts sent interceptor drones and team to help U.S. base in Jordan. 6 U.S. service members were killed with Iranian drones in Kuwait since the U.S.-Israeli War against Iran started February 28, 2026. There is a deal Ukraine proposed last year to the White House on producing a hive mind drone system.

OPTIONS:

1. Take all the help from Ukraine we can get and support them.
Action: Sign the drone production deal, give them money.
Pros: Shows U.S. public we are using all available resources, not inadvertently funding Russia against Ukraine with oil, pleases Ukraine.
Cons: Might be costly, details of drone deal unclear.
2. Use what Ukraine has offered and support them.
Action: Do not sign deal but give them money.
Pros: Still get tech and knowledge.
Cons: Might anger Ukraine with deal, lose money.
3. Continue with what we've done so far.
Action: Do not sign deal, accept technology and team help, don't give them money.
Pros: U.S. won't be further drawn in to Ukraine War, legally allowed.
Cons: Public will not approve, angers Ukraine, other middle eastern countries also using Ukraine support other better deal will not prioritize U.S., bad precedent for future.

RECOMMENDATION: That you approve Option 1. Take all the help from Ukraine, sign the deal with conditions that the U.S. will approve and give them money, boosts public support for U.S.-Israeli and Iran War. This puts U.S. national security and its soldiers as the highest priority and indicates interest in furthering fight against Russia, stands with middle eastern countries.



[Bloomberg](#)



[CNN](#)

Dmytro Chubenko of the Kharkiv regional prosecutor's office examines the carbon fiber remains of a Russian-made, Iran-designed Shahed-136 drone in Kharkiv, Ukraine, on July 30, 2025. (Scott Peterson/Getty Images)